The .NET CLI works well for generating tokens, but you need a way to add this token to a request. Specifically, if you're using OpenAPI definitions and Swagger UI as described in chapter 11, you need a way to tell Swagger about your authentication requirements. In section 25.5 you'll learn about some of the authentication configuration options for your OpenAPI documents and how to use Swagger UI to send authenticated requests to your API.

Finally, in section 25.6 I show how to apply authorization policies to minimal API endpoints to restrict which users can call your APIs. The authorization concepts you learned about in chapter 24 for Razor Pages are the same for APIs, so you're still using claims, requirements, handlers, and polices.

We'll start off by looking at how authentication works when you have an API application. Many of the authentication concepts are similar to traditional apps, but the requirement to support multiple types of users, traditional apps, client-side apps, and mobile apps has led to subtly different solutions.

25.1 Authentication for APIs and distributed applications

In this section you'll learn about the authentication process for API applications, why it typically differs from authentication for traditional web apps, and some of the common patterns and protocols that are involved.

25.1.1 Extending authentication to multiple apps